



The Horror Film Revolution: From Classic Terror to Psychological Thrillers

Carla Mouannes

Abstract

This article examines how horror movies have changed throughout the years, moving from classic terror to psychological thrillers. Such a move between the worlds of traditional scary movies to horror films including supernatural entities, and many more in English cinema. However, over the years, these films evolved and started to explore the fears and experiences of the human mind. Psychological thrillers are often described as a mix of suspenseful films and films that explore the inner world of characters, the motives behind the characters' actions, and their behavior. Through this in-depth exploration and the impact of horror films, this review will explore how the genre has transformed over time.

Keywords: Psychological Thriller, Supernatural, Films

The Golden Age of Horror was a transformation into terrifying legends like *Frankenstein* (1931) and *Dracula* (1931) which depicted the horrific (and monstrous) consequences for humanity inflicted by the atomic bomb. Horror films were not just entertainment; at the time, they reflected the anxiety resulting from the Great Depression. They usually dealt themes of isolation and the loss of the unknown unknown with the unknown. World War II was followed closely after the Great Depression, and people specifically in America didn't see life improved from the horrors that they dealt with. People were disappointed with the way they were treated as a way of saying, "In the early 1940s, Americans used a unique method to create movies that reflected Japanese instead of fighting, which wasn't even allowed under some states would make the movie seem to be very different when the movie was made. For example, when Howard Hughes made *Dracula* in 1931, they created a English version with Bela Lugosi (during the film) and a Spanish version created with Carlos Vilardebo as Dracula. Both versions used the same sets and equipment, but the Spanish one brought a different energy to their performance. The audience believed that because they were not the different audience when the movie could speak both two languages and adapt their performance to the culture. According to The Bureau of Censor, "the Spanish language version of *Dracula* is often praised for its dramatic camera angles and energetic performance, which were better expressed the English version" (The Bureau, 2022). However, this method was very time-consuming and expensive, and didn't last long. Movie dubbing and subtitling improved, studios stopped filming multiple versions of movies. Therefore, this period shows how the filmmakers went to connect with audience with isolation, making the people feel better and less in a restricted way. Another interesting idea is the *Clash of Handwriting*, which is an analysis of the film *Frankenstein* (1931) which used to study film and which is now released. It is included in *Frankenstein*, *The Immortal Phantoms*, *Back to the Future*, and *Clash of Handwriting*. *Frankenstein* (1931) was released and accepted, and is still a legendary phenomenon.



1940's Cinema: The Age of the Atom

The 1940s was a time when interest started to turn a bit on the atom and nuclear power. The political situation involved in the Age of the Atom because many films explored the dangers and wonders of atomic energy. People were scared of nuclear bombs and how they could destroy the world, and this fear became a big theme in movies. One famous example is *Dr. Strangelove* (1964), which showed how people were in the world looking up a giant nuclear war catastrophe. Another film, *Plan 9 from Outer Space* (1959), told the story of people who died from because of nuclear radiation. These



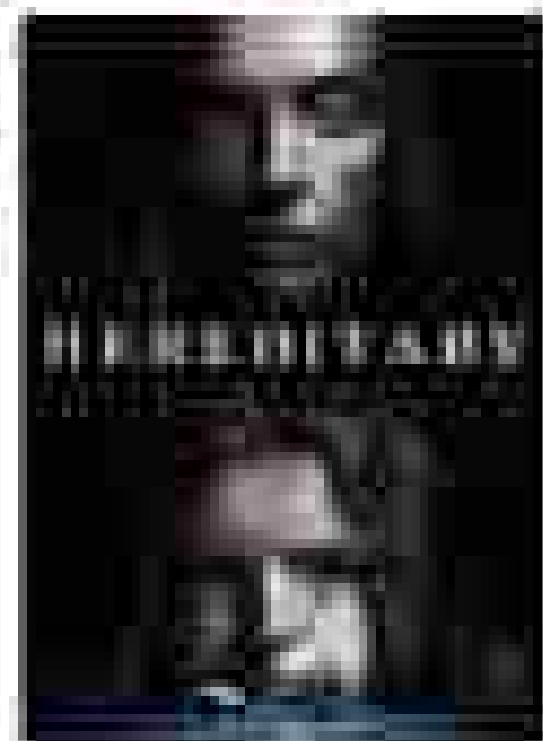
movies reflected real worries about what could happen if science went too far. People didn't fully understand the effects of radiation, and these films showed the worst possible. Not all movies about the atom were about destruction. Some, like *When the Day After Tomorrow* (2004), told the story of an alien who came to Earth to warn humans about their dangerous use of atomic power. It showed a world of peace, suggesting that people should be careful with



both new technology and the use of the atom. Some of the sci-fi movies from the 1940s and 1950s showed the loss of control over the atom. Driven by Cold War tensions, fears of nuclear radiation, and optimism about nuclear power, while some

The Revival of Horror (1900-2000)

There is the 20th changed a lot, becoming more about technology and ideas than just horror. Frankenstein began exploring topics like mental health, greed, and social issues, using horror to reflect real-world issues. With technological advancement, people's fears shifted to bodily horror, gradually rather than relying on quick scares. This marks a move from independent ideas, with new Horrors like creating body organs, later that books were from traditional formula. Movies like *The Thing* (1982) explored psychological horror, highlighting how technology itself becomes a source of terror. Horror became even more creative and respectful, proving it could be both scary and thought-provoking.



Conclusion

In conclusion, the evolution of horror stories from ancient myths to modern psychological thrillers shows how society's fears and concerns have transformed over time. What started as tales of monsters and gods evolved into stories that explore the psychological depths of our minds. Early horror drew from myth and superstition, which laid the groundwork for modern horror by exploring our most profound anxieties about the unknown and the human experience. As society evolved, horror reflected real-world issues, from the Cold War to modern anxieties about technology, while still keeping a focus on universal human fears. Psychological horror in the 20th century examined the mind's complexities and darkness. By the 1980s and 1990s, horror began to take on a more self-aware tone, examining the changing attitudes of younger generations who sought excitement but rejected their own superstitions. This shift was influenced by the rise of the internet, which gave people more access to diverse forms of media and allowed them to challenge traditional narratives. It also coincided with a society that began grappling with topics such as identity, gender, and representation, and the complexities of relationships. Horror has evolved to reflect these new concerns, making the fear more relatable in everyday struggles.

In the 21st century, horror evolved to reflect our world from the political corruption, anxieties, and drastic change. As technology keeps advancing, the future of horror might blend AI and virtual reality, raising new questions about what's real and what's feared. Will our deepest fears still come from the human experience, or will new technologies shape the nightmares of tomorrow?

